

Even Keel

The December 2026 CEA link — the proposal in ten minutes

For managers · 26 weeks · code EK-26-H1 · the full proposal sheet has the detail

The short version

Four numbers

9 of 9

December rules met

today’s link: 4

35h

contracted hours a week

Mon–Sat average

0

avoidable fatigue warnings

fixed rota · today 4

26

people on the link

today: 20

Every December rule met — and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The staffing you asked for

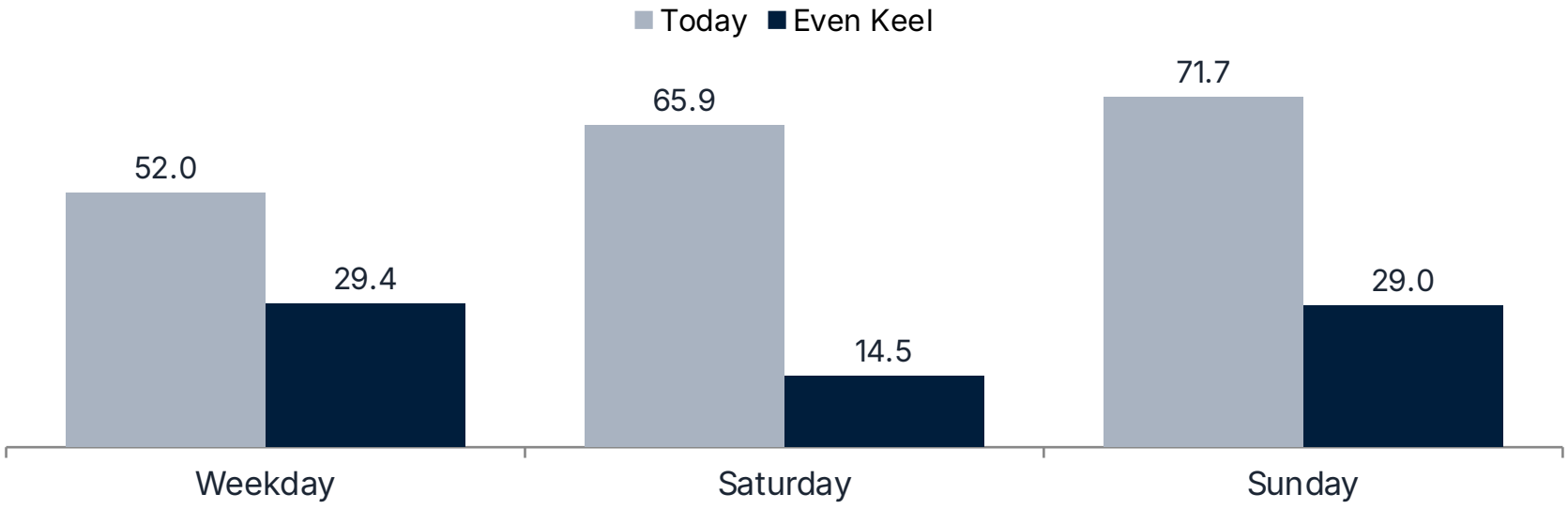
Weekday · Saturday · Sunday

	Today	Even Keel
On duty during the day	11–12 · 10 · 8	**15 · 14 · 10**
At the open (06:20, Sunday 07:15)	4 · 4 · 3	**5 · 5 · 4**
Still on after 22:00	4 · 2 · 3	**7 · 5 · 5**
Through to the close	2 · 2 · 3	**3 · 4 · 3**
Fewest rostered on the floor	2 · 2 · 2	**3 · 3 · 3**

Every level met on every day — and the ticket office staffed in pairs, including Sundays.

People where the trains are

How far the floor staffing is from the shape of the December timetable — lower is better



Much closer to the December pattern every day. The score: hour by hour, how far staffing sits from the trains; 0 would track them exactly.

People and hours

What it takes to run

	Today	Even Keel
People on the link	20	**26**
Contracted hours a week	35h	**35h**
Cover weeks (for leave and sickness)	4 in 20 (1 in 5)	**5 in 26 (1 in 5.2)**
People needed each Sunday (overtime)	8	**10**

Six more people, 35 hours a week on average; Sunday overtime 83h 30m a week across the link (today 68h 15m).

Fatigue checks

Against the Office of Rail and Road's good-practice list and the rail industry's own checks

	Today	Even Keel
Avoidable fatigue warnings, fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	**0**
Most days in a row (limit 13)	7 (up to 9)	**5 (up to 6)**
Shortest rest between shifts (limit 12h)	12h 30m	**14h 35m**
Longest shift	9h 10m	**9h 00m**

Rest and run limits met with room to spare; no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

Why Even Keel?

What all four shortlisted links give, what this one adds, and what it costs

- ✓ All four shortlisted: all 9 December rules and no avoidable fatigue warning
- ✓ All four shortlisted: about 14 full weekends off a year (today 10), at most 5 apart
- ✓ All four shortlisted: no shift over 9 hours, and every closing shift shorter
- ✓ This one adds: a fourth person to the Saturday close (the others 3, today 2)
- ✓ 8 of 15 shift times worked today; 7 new, several shorter versions of today’s lates
- – Costs: 44 late finishes (today 39), a mixed week, four weeks off 15 days, not 14

Late finishes: 44 a year each (today 39) — two above the rules’ minimum, buying a fourth person to the Saturday close. The colleague deck shows every cost openly.

What colleagues will notice

The good and the not so good — the colleague presentation shows both

Likely to welcome

- 14 full weekends off a year (today 10)
- One turn in 18 of 21 weeks (today 7 of 16)
- At most 5 days in a row, fixed rota (today 7)
- No week over 41h 30m Monday to Saturday
- Shortest rest 14h 35m (today 12h 30m)

Likely to worry about

- Late finishes: 44 a year (today 39)
- 7 new shift times to learn, 2 on a Saturday
- Average shift about 2 minutes longer
- Best 14-day leave stretch 28 days, not 30
- Four weeks off needs 15 days' leave, not 14

Expect late finishes to be the first question — the colleague deck answers it openly.

Where it stands

Three things confirmed verbally, two decisions left, two points still open

✓ **December rules — confirmed**
The nine December rules. Everything here is built on them.

✓ **26 people on the link — confirmed**
Six more than today, with five cover weeks.

✓ **Sunday cover — confirmed**
Ten on a Sunday — Sunday work stays overtime.

? **To decide: which link we use**
Colleagues' views come first.

? **Then: who starts on which line**
Who begins on which week. Open: the 13-day limit's written source; the FF19 reading.

Colleagues' views come first; the link is chosen after them, then who starts where.



The detail

- Every week of the link, day by day
- Staff on duty hour by hour, against the trains
- Every December rule and fatigue check, worked through

All in the eight-page proposal sheet · Even Keel · EK-26-H1